President Herzog, which was accepted by leaders of the opposition but staunchly opposed by most members of the coalition.

In three days is Tisha B'Av, the yearly commemoration of the destruction of both Temples in Jerusalem. Nothing could be more symbolic of Israel's present situation. In the seventy-five years of the country's existence, there was never a crisis as critical to its very survival as the present one.

Monday, July 24

The Knesset voted for the cancelation of the plausibility law by the 64 votes of the coalition and total abstention of the opposition. Before the vote, Minister of Defense Gallant and the minister of justice had a sharp exchange, but Gallant ultimately voted with the coalition, even though he purports to be in favor of halting the judicial overhaul in view of the situation in the armed forces. Why? The same question can be asked about President Herzog: why do these people not have the courage to resign when so much is at stake and their gesture would carry so much meaning?

Will the decision of the government be brought to the Supreme Court before Chief Justice Hayut retires in a month or so? At this moment, the chief justice is in Germany. She is hastening back.

Netanyahu, in a speech full of lies about the past and a mellifluous description of the future unity of both sides, added his bits and pieces of disinformation. He is a prisoner of the extremists in the coalition and speaks for them. Their voice is his voice. Both Lapid and Gantz answered with firmness and dignity.

Protests continue throughout the country with renewed intensity, and the police is increasing its violent response. A long war of attrition has begun on the streets.